

SOF IGKO — Unit 3 Deep-Dive

India & The World

Class III • Parent-readable notes

What this unit is about

India's national symbols, geography, history, and festivals — plus a few famous places and capitals around the world.

1. National symbols of India (memorise these)

Symbol	Answer
Capital	New Delhi
National animal	Tiger
National bird	Peacock
National flower	Lotus
National fruit	Mango
National tree	Banyan
National game	Hockey
National anthem	Jana Gana Mana
National song	Vande Mataram

2. The national flag (Tiranga)

- **Saffron (top)** — courage and sacrifice.
- **White (middle)** — peace and truth. It holds the **Ashoka Chakra** (blue wheel with **24 spokes**) → progress and movement.
- **Green (bottom)** — growth and prosperity.

3. Geography of India

- **Tallest mountains:** the **Himalayas** (in the north).
- **Longest / holy river:** the **Ganga** (Ganges). Others: Yamuna, Brahmaputra, Kaveri.
- **Largest desert:** the **Thar** desert.
- **Oceans/seas around India:** Indian Ocean (south), Arabian Sea (west), Bay of Bengal (east).

4. History & freedom

- India became **independent on 15 August 1947**.
- **Father of the Nation:** Mahatma Gandhi.
- India became a **Republic on 26 January 1950** (Republic Day).

5. Famous monuments

- **Taj Mahal** — Agra. **Red Fort / Qutub Minar** — Delhi. **Gateway of India** — Mumbai.

6. The world beyond India

Country	Capital	Famous landmark
USA	Washington D.C.	Statue of Liberty
UK	London	Big Ben
France	Paris	Eiffel Tower
China	Beijing	Great Wall
Japan	Tokyo	—
Egypt	Cairo	Pyramids

- **Neighbours of India:** Pakistan, Nepal, Bhutan, China, Bangladesh, Sri Lanka, Myanmar.
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Common exam traps

- **Independence Day = 15 August, Republic Day = 26 January** — don't mix them.
- The **Taj Mahal is in Agra**, not Delhi or Mumbai.
- **Peacock** is the national bird; **tiger** the national animal; **lotus** the flower.

- The **Himalayas are in the north** — travelling towards them means going *north*.
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Quick recall

1. Capital of India → **New Delhi**
2. National bird / animal / flower → **peacock / tiger / lotus**
3. Independence → **15 August 1947**; Republic Day → **26 January**
4. Longest river → **Ganga**; tallest mountains → **Himalayas**
5. Father of the Nation → **Mahatma Gandhi**
6. Eiffel Tower → **Paris**; Statue of Liberty → **USA**; Great Wall → **China**